

Scrum Values

The Foundation of High-Performance Teams

A Comprehensive Guide to the Five Core Values

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Overview

- **Five Core Values:** Commitment, Courage, Focus, Openness, Respect
- **Cultural Foundation:** Guide team behavior and decision-making
- **Enablers of Success:** Make the three Scrum pillars effective
- **Behavioral Framework:** Create trust and psychological safety

Values Enable the Three Pillars

Transparency

Making work visible to everyone

Inspection

Reviewing progress regularly

Adaptation

Adjusting based on learning

Commitment

Definition: Each Scrum Team member commits to achieving the team's goals and supporting each other.

- **Personal Accountability:** Team members take ownership of Sprint goals
- **Quality Focus:** Delivering value and maintaining high standards
- **Empiricism:** Making decisions based on data and evidence

Commitment - Detailed Explanation

What it means in practice: Team members pledge to deliver on their promises. This includes:

- Making realistic commitments during Sprint Planning
- Supporting teammates when they face challenges
- Focusing on quality over quick delivery
- Learning continuously to improve processes

Courage

Definition: Scrum Team members need courage to do the right thing and face tough problems.

- **Exploration:** Exploring the unknown and taking calculated risks
- **Change:** Changing direction when data supports it
- **Communication:** Sharing information openly and engaging in disagreements

Courage - Detailed Explanation

Real-world examples of courage in Scrum:

- Speaking up about impediments in Daily Standups
- Admitting mistakes and learning from them
- Challenging assumptions when evidence contradicts them
- Advocating for technical excellence even under pressure

Focus

Definition: The Scrum Team focuses on the work of the Sprint and its goals.

- **Concentration:** Prioritizing what's currently most important
- **Value Creation:** Creating value and achieving Sprint objectives
- **Definition of Done:** Getting work to Done status

Focus - Detailed Explanation

How to maintain focus in teams:

- Limiting work-in-progress to prevent multitasking
- Aligning all activities to Sprint and Product goals
- Reducing distractions and interruptions
- Completing committed work before taking on new items

Openness

Definition: The team and stakeholders are open about all work and challenges.

- **Transparency:** Being transparent about progress and struggles
- **Feedback Culture:** Sharing feedback and learning from each other
- **Stakeholder Collaboration:** Engaging openly with stakeholders

Openness - Detailed Explanation

Building an open culture:

- Discussing challenges honestly without fear
- Creating psychological safety for all voices
- Sharing both successes and failures transparently
- Inviting diverse perspectives to improve solutions

Respect

Definition: Scrum Team members respect each other as skilled professionals.

- **Diverse Expertise:** Valuing different skills and perspectives
- **Disagreement:** Being respectful when perspectives differ
- **Independence:** Recognizing capability and autonomy

Respect - Detailed Explanation

Demonstrating respect in practice:

- Actively listening to all perspectives in meetings
- Valuing domain expertise and technical knowledge
- Supporting professional growth and learning
- Resolving conflicts constructively and courteously

How Values Work Together

- **Build Trust:** Values create psychological safety and team cohesion
- **Enable Collaboration:** Facilitate effective communication and teamwork
- **Improve Delivery:** Lead to consistent, high-quality value delivery
- **Support Adaptation:** Create environment for continuous improvement

Implementing Values in Your Team

- **Retrospectives:** Reflect on how well values are embodied
- **Workshops:** Define observable behaviors for each value
- **Daily Practice:** Demonstrate values in standups and interactions
- **Feedback:** Provide constructive feedback on value alignment

The Values Drive Success

When teams embody Commitment, Courage, Focus, Openness, and Respect, they unlock the full potential of Scrum.

Build a culture. Transform your team. Deliver value.